the friction this causes, you need to look closer at these two languages, Scheme and Self.

1.3.2. Scheme

Scheme is a general-purpose programming language created by Guy Steele and Gerald Sussman. It's considered a *dialect* of the programming language Lisp, which the late John McCarthy created when he was a young man. Lisp dialects don't look like the C programming language at all.

Over time, the popularity of Lisp dialects waned while the popularity of the C programming language grew. Finally, when Brendan Eich created the C-resembling JavaScript language to be used in the web browser of a company called Netscape, all of McCarthy's hair was gray. Lisp dialects might have been moderately popular choices for programming languages when men in rock bands had perms, but they were no longer popular by the time Eich created JavaScript. Because they weren't popular, there was no way that JavaScript was going to look like one of them. But Lisp contained some powerful programming ideas that JavaScript needed, so, syntax aside, there was nothing preventing it from being inspired by Lisp.

The ideas that JavaScript takes from Scheme have foundations in a mathematical system called *lambda calculus*. In terms of modern computer programming, some of these ideas fall under the term *functional programming*, which is the style of programming encouraged by Scheme. Functional programming very loosely means programming with functions (which you'll start to learn about in chapter 3). How about C? The style of programming encouraged by C is called *imperative programming*. JavaScript has the syntax of C, but it was inspired, in a small but important way, by the functional style of Scheme.

While the popularity of Lisp and the functional programming style was declining, another programming style called *object-oriented programming* was starting to gain popularity. An object-oriented language called Self was the basis of a core idea in JavaScript called *prototypes*.